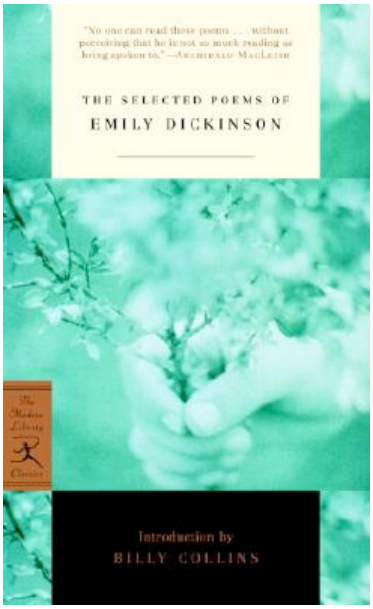
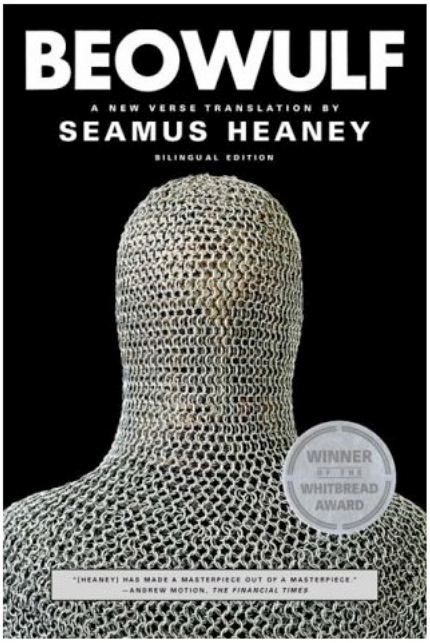
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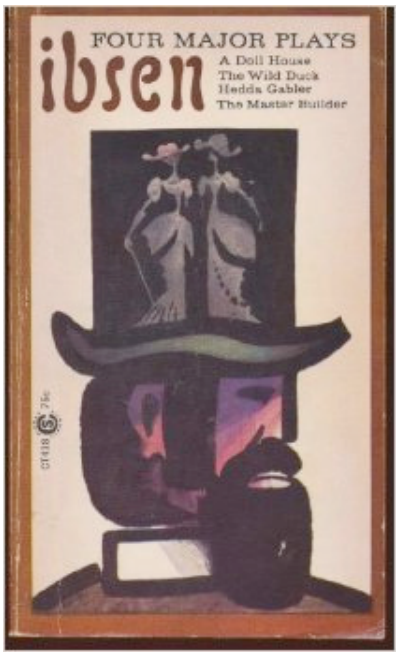
Making a World of Difference

Literary Criticism

District 2 • 2015







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University Interscholastic League
Literary Criticism Contest • District 2 • 2015

Part 1: Knowledge of Literary Terms and of Literary History **30 items (1 point each)**

1. A pause or break in a line of verse, which in classical poetry usually occurs near the middle of a line, is the

   A) cadence.
   B) caesura.
   C) chiasmus.
   D) elision.
   E) enjambment.

2. The authors John Barbour, Adam Smith, David Hume, Alexander Montgomerie, John Knox, Walter Scott, and Robert Burns represent the body of

   A) African American literature.
   B) Irish literature.
   C) Jewish American literature.
   D) Scottish literature.
   E) Welsh literature.

3. The device of repetition in which the same expression (word or words) is repeated as the beginning of two or more lines, clauses, or sentences is known as

   A) anaphora.
   B) epanalepsis.
   C) merism.
   D) ploce.
   E) polyptoton.

4. The American author of *A Farewell to Arms*, *The Old Man and the Sea*, and *For Whom the Bell Tolls* and recipient of the 1954 Nobel Prize for Literature is

   A) Saul Bellow.
   B) Joseph Brodsky.
   C) William Faulkner.
   D) Ernest Hemingway.
   E) Sinclair Lewis.

5. The early nineteenth-century New York literary society that includes Washington Irving, James Fenimore Cooper, and William Cullen Bryant, and which was based more on geography and chance rather than on close organization, is the

   A) Fireside Poets.
   B) Hartford Wits.
   C) Knickerbocker Group.
   D) Muckrakers.
   E) New York School.

6. **Not** a term used to designate a poet or a musician, often one who travels, who tells stories of great deeds, love, or chivalry is

   A) bard.
   B) braggadocio.
   C) gleeman.
   D) scop.
   E) troubadour.

7. The dramatic convention by which an actor directly addresses the audience but is not supposed to be heard by the other actors on stage is

   A) apostrophe.
   B) aside.
   C) dramatic monologue.
   D) harangue.
   E) soliloquy.

8. The imagist poet who authored the poetry collection *Pictures from Brueghel* for which he won the 1963 Pulitzer Prize for Poetry posthumously is

   A) Wallace Stevens.
   B) Peter Viereck.
   C) Robert Penn Warren.
   D) Richard Wilbur.
   E) William Carlos Williams.

9. The period in English literature (1700-1750) that encompasses the reign of Queen Anne and the flourishing of Alexander Pope is called the

   A) Augustan Age.
   B) Caroline Age.
   C) Edwardian Age.
   D) Elizabethan Age.
   E) Jacobean Age.

10. The Polish-born Jewish-American author of the short story collection *The Magic Barrel* and the novels *The Natural* (which was made into a film), *The Assistant*, and *The Fixe*r, for which he received the 1967 Pulitzer Prize for Fiction is

    A) Bernard Malamud.
    B) Philip Roth.
    C) J. D. Salinger.
    D) Isaac Bashevis Singer.
    E) Wallace Stegner.

11. The gathering of writers and thinkers, many of whom lived in a residential district near central London, after which the group takes its name, the collective counting among its membership Virginia Woolf, Lytton Strachey, E. M. Forster, and John Maynard Keynes, among others, is the

A) Bloomsbury Group.
B) Bluestockings.
C) Fugitives.
D) Knickerbocker Group.
E) Scriblerus Club.

12. The phenomenon in which a syllable both begins and ends phonetically in the same way as a rhyming syllable, without being the same word is called

A) compound rhyme.
B) eye rhyme.
C) identical rhyme.
D) leonine rhyme.
E) masculine rhyme.

13. **Not** designated by Edmund Burke as one of the four master tropes (master because of their role in the discovery and description of "the truth") is

A) irony.
B) metaphor.
C) metonymy.
D) simile.
E) synecdoche.

14. The twentieth-century Chinese-American author of *The Joy Luck Club* and *Sagwa, the Chinese-Siamese Cat* is

A) Maxine Hong Kingston.
B) Michelle Kwan.
C) Ursula Le Guin.
D) Amy Tan.
E) Gao Xingjian.

15. The seventeenth-century English poet and essayist whose *Paradise Lost*, *Paradise Regained*, and *Areopagitica* underscore Harold Bloom's argument regarding the importance of this author's contribution to the British canon is

A) Francis Bacon.
B) John Donne.
C) Ben Jonson.
D) John Milton.
E) Henry Vaughan.

16. The French verse pattern that is artificial but very popular with many English-language poets and which consists of fifteen lines, the ninth and fifteenth being a short refrain, and which has only two rhymes (exclusive of the refrain) is the

A) bouts-rimés.
B) *chant royal*.
C) pantoum.
D) pastourelle.
E) rondeau.

17. Commonplace in literature and movies, the character serving as a mysterious look-alike is known as a(n)

A) braggadocio.
B) doppelgänger.
C) *femme fatale*.
D) ingénue.
E) twiner.

18. In earlier forms of a language, a word for which there is a single recorded occurrence is known as a

A) euphemism.
B) kenning.
C) nonce word.
D) pun.
E) repartee.

19. A character who changes little if at all is known as a

A) dynamic character.
B) flat character.
C) round character.
D) static character.
E) stock character.

20. The nineteenth-century American essayist, orator, and member of the Transcendental Club, whose delivery of the "Harvard Divinity School Address" and the Phi Beta Kappa address, "The American Scholar" has enshrined him in history is

A) William Cullen Bryant.
B) Ralph Waldo Emerson.
C) Oliver Wendell Holmes.
D) William Dean Howells.
E) Henry David Thoreau.

21. A listing of people, things, or attributes as a characteristic of primitive literature, e.g., epics, as well as not-so-primitive literature, e.g., art epics, is called a(n)

A) archive.
B) catalog.
C) chrestomathy.
D) index.
E) miscellany.

22. The eighteenth-century Anglo-Irish novelist, playwright, and poet whose *The Vicar of Wakefield*, *She Stoops to Conquer*, and *The Deserted Village* earned him membership in Johnson's Literary Club is

A) George Berkeley.
B) Edmund Burke.
C) Oliver Goldsmith.
D) Laurence Sterne.
E) Jonathan Swift.

23. The appellation by which the nineteenth-century English Romantics William Wordsworth, Samuel Taylor Coleridge, and Robert Southey have come to be known is the

A) Black Mountain School.
B) Cockney School.
C) Graveyard School.
D) Kailyard School.
E) Lake School.

24. An interrogative statement propounded for its stylistic or oratorical effect and not requiring a reply or intended to induce a reply is a(n)

A) dialectic.
B) equivoque.
C) objective correlative.
D) rhetorical accent.
E) rhetorical question.

25. The name for certain young scholars, including Christopher Marlowe and Thomas Kyd, who came to London in the late 1580s, undertook careers as professional writers, and played an important part in the development of great literature is

A) Inkhornists.
B) Literary Club.
C) Scriblerus Club.
D) Stationers' Company.
E) University Wits.

26. A poem that reveals "a soul in action" through the speech of one character in a dramatic situation is called (a)

A) dramatic irony.
B) dramaticle.
C) dramedy.
D) dramatic monologue.
E) dramatic personae.

27. The often ludicrous effect, intended or otherwise, resulting from the unsuccessful effort to achieve dignity or sublimity of style is known as

A) bathos.
B) ethos.
C) logos.
D) mythos.
E) pathos.

28. **Not** the eighteenth- or nineteenth-century literary period in which historical and religious concerns, ***or*** the romantic spirit, ***or*** pragmatic verisimilitude characterizes the literature is the

A) Colonial Period.
B) Period of Confessional Self.
C) Realistic Period.
D) Revolutionary Period.
E) Romantic Period.

29. Often performed at UIL One-Act Play contests, *Harvey*, which was awarded the 1945 Pulitzer Prize for Drama, was written by

A) Mary Chase.
B) Ketti Frings.
C) David Lindsay-Abaire.
D) Marsha Norman.
E) Neil Simon.

30. A work of fiction, a major concern of which is the nature of fiction itself, such as Miguel de Cervantes' *Don Quixote*, John Barth's *Lost in the Funhouse*, and John Fowles's *The French Lieutenant's Woman*, is known as (a/an)

A) epistolary novel.
B) framework-story.
C) leitmotif.
D) metafiction.
E) palimpsest.

Part 2: The UIL Reading List **20 items (2 points each)**

Items 31-36 are associated with Henrik Ibsen's *A Doll House*.
Items 37-42 are associated with Seamus Heaney's translation of *Beowulf.*
Items 43-50 are associated with Emily Dickinson's poetry (selected).

31. In Ibsen's *A Doll House* the threat "I'm telling you this: if I get shoved down a second time, you're going to keep me company" is delivered by
    A) Nils to Helene.
    B) Nils to Kristine.
    C) Nils to Nora.
    D) Torvald to Kristine.
    E) Torvald to Nora.

32. Central to Nora's comment to Kristine, "Being a lawyer is such an uncertain living [. . .] especially if one won't touch any cases that aren't clean and decent," is a reference to
    A) Bob.
    B) Ivar.
    C) Nils.
    D) Rank.
    E) Torvald.

33. The admonitory observation that "[p]lenty of men have redeemed themselves by openly confessing their crimes and taking their punishment" is strong advice given by
    A) Kristine to Nora.
    B) Nils to Nora.
    C) Nora to Kristine.
    D) Rank to Nora.
    E) Torvald to Nora.

34. The "better hands" to which Nora refers in her riposte, "Good-bye, Torvald. I won't look in on the children. I know they're in better hands than mine," are
    A) Anne-Marie's.
    B) Emmy's.
    C) Helene's.
    D) Kristine's.
    E) Torvald's.

35. Revealingly, the object of Helmer's question, "Why shouldn't I look at my dearest possession?" is his
    A) bank portfolio.
    B) copy of the forged document that saved his life.
    C) gold-framed family tree.
    D) oldest son.
    E) wife.

36. Mrs. Linde's revelation that "[t]here was a time once when he'd gladly have done anything for me" is referring to
    A) Helmer.
    B) Krogstad.
    C) Linde's first husband.
    D) Rank.
    E) Torvald.

37. In Heaney's *Beowulf* the son of Ecgtheow announces that he and his retainers have "come in good faith to find [the watchman's] lord / and nation's shield, the son of Halfdane," specifically, to find
    A) Beow.
    B) Beowulf.
    C) Hrothgar.
    D) Hygelac.
    E) Ongentheow.

38. Heaney's translation of the Old English word *wist*, which means 'feasting,' as 'wassail' in "Grendel's powers of destruction were plain: their wassail was over" constitutes (a)
    A) barbarism.
    B) heteronym.
    C) hyperbole.
    D) synecdoche.
    E) transvocalization.

39. "As God is my witness, / I would rather my body were robed in the same / burning blaze as my gold-giver's body" prefaces an action undertaken by
    A) Aeschere.
    B) Beowulf.
    C) Hygelac.
    D) Unferth.
    E) Wiglaf.

40. The "hall session that harrowed every Dane / inside the stockade" is the
    A) distribution of mead by Wealhtheow.
    B) fight between Grendel and Beowulf.
    C) flyting undertaken by Unferth.
    D) greeting of the Geats by the Danes.
    E) redistribution of booty by Hrothgar.

41. **Not** among the peoples that Wiglaf lists as potential enemies upon the death of the king, Beowulf, are the

A) Franks.
B) Frisians.
C) Geats.
D) Hetware.
E) Swedes.

42. Beowulf cuts Grendel's head off

A) after he kills the dragon.
B) after he severs the tarn-hag's neck-bone.
C) during the battle in the mead hall.
D) while he chases him through the fens.
E) while searching for Grendel's mother.

Items 43-47 refer to Emily Dickinson's

[I like to see it lap the miles]

I like to see it lap the miles,
And lick the valleys up,
And stop to feed itself at tanks;
And then, prodigious, step

Around a pile of mountains,
And, supercilious, peer
In shanties by the sides of roads;
And then a quarry pare

To fit its sides, and crawl between
Complaining all the while
In horrid, hooting stanza;
Then chase itself down hill

And neigh like Boanerges;
Then, punctual as a star,
Stop—docile and omnipotent—
At its own stable door.

43. The dynamic progress through Dickinson's "[I like to see it lap the miles]" is reinforced by

A) anadiplosis.
B) elision.
C) enjambment.
D) onomatopoeia.
E) reduplication.

44. Line 6's "supercilious" means

A) cautiously.
B) fanatically.
C) maniacally.
D) pridefully
E) tautological.

45. The poem's rhyme scheme depends on

A) assonance.
B) consonance.
C) dissonance.
D) feminine endings.
E) sigmatism.

46. Line 13's "neigh like Boanerges" is a

A) biblical allusion.
B) classical allusion.
C) historical allusion.
D) literary allusion.
E) topical allusion.

47. The subject of Dickinson's poem is a(n)

A) athlete.
B) horse.
C) owl.
D) storm.
E) train.

Items 48-50 refer to Emily Dickinson's

[I heard a fly buzz when I died]

I heard a fly buzz when I died;
The stillness round my form
Was like the stillness in the air
Between the heaves of storm.

The eyes beside had wrung them dry,
And breaths were gathering sure
For that last onset, when the king
Be witnessed in his power.

I willed my keepsakes, signed away
What portion of me I
Could make assignable,—and then
There interposed a fly,

With blue, uncertain, stumbling buzz,
Between the light and me;
And then the windows failed, and then
I could not see.

48. The imagery of Dickinson's poem is primarily

A) auditory.
B) gustatory.
C) olfactory.
D) tactile.
E) visual.

49. The figure of speech that enlivens line 13 is

A) apostrophe.
B) conceit.
C) irony.
D) mimesis.
E) synæsthesia.

50. Thematically, Dickinson's poem, which focuses on the threshold that is death, is concerned with

A) aesthetic distance.
B) kenosis.
C) liminality.
D) luminism.
E) ratiocination.

Part 3: Ability in Literary Criticism
15 items (2 points each)

Items 51-53 refer to the Anglo-Saxon Poem

The Wife's Lament

Sorrowfully I sing my song of woe,
My tale of trials. In truth I may say
That the buffets I have borne since my birth in the world
Were never more than now, either new or old.
Ever the evils of exile I endure!
Long since went my lord from the land of his birth,
Over the welling waves. Woeful at dawn I asked
Where lingers my lord, in what land does he dwell?
Then I fared into far lands and faithfully sought him,
A weary wanderer in want of comfort.
His treacherous tribesmen contrived a plot,
Dark and dastardly, to drive us apart
The width of a world, where with weary hearts
We live in loneliness, and longing consumes me.
My master commanded me to make my home here.
Alas, in this land my loved ones are few,
My faithful friends! Hence I feel great sorrow
That the man well-matched with me I have found
To be sad in soul and sorrowful in mind,
Concealing his thoughts and thinking of murder,
Though blithe in his bearing. Oft we bound us by oath
That the day of our death should draw us apart,
Nothing less end our love. Alas, all is changed!
Now is as naught, as if never it were,
Our faith and our friendship. Far and near I shall
Endure the hate of one dear to my heart!
He condemned me to dwell in a darksome wood,
Under an oak-tree in an earth-cave drear.
Old is the earth-hall. I am anxious with longing.
Dim are the dales, dark the hills tower,
Bleak the tribe-dwellings, with briars entangled,
Unblessed abodes. Here bitterly I have suffered
The faring of my lord afar. Friends there are on earth
Living in love, in lasting bliss,
While, wakeful at dawn, I wander alone
Under the oak-tree the earth-cave near.
Sadly, I sit there the summer-long day,
Wearily weeping my woeful exile,
My many miseries. Hence I may not ever
Cease my sorrowing, my sad bewailing,
Nor all the longings of my life of woe.
Always may the young man be mournful of spirit,
Unhappy of heart, and have as his portion
Many sorrows of soul, unceasing breast-cares,
Though now blithe of behavior. Unbearable likewise
Be his joys in the world. Wide be his exile
To far-away folk-lands where my friend sits alone,
A stranger under stone-cliffs, by storm made hoary,
A weary-souled wanderer, by waters encompassed,
In his lonely lodging. My lover endures
Unmeasured mind-care: he remembers too oft
A happier home. To him is fate cruel
Who lingers and longs for the loved one's return!

Trans. Friedrich Kluge

51. Overall, the tone of "The Wife's Lament" is

A) apologetic.
B) condescending.
C) elegiac.
D) indignant.
E) morose.

52. The separation to which the wife refers (lines 17-25) seems to have become indubitable in light of the

A) approach of Judgment Day.
B) arrival of faithful friends.
C) husband's deceptive bearing.
D) overuse of alliteration.
E) wearied loneliness despite faith and friendship.

53. The wife's closing remarks (lines 51-53) suggest the

A) despair of exile.
B) favored status of mind-care.
C) husband's deception.
D) return of the weary-souled wanderer.
E) speaker's generous humanity.

Items 54-58 refer to Elizabeth Barrett Browning's

To George Sand:* A Recognition

True genius, but true woman! dost deny
The woman's nature with a manly scorn
And break away the gauds and armlets worn **jewelry**
By weaker women in captivity? 4
Ah, vain denial! that revolted cry
Is sobbed in by a woman's voice forlorn,
Thy woman's hair, my sister, all unshorn
Floats back dishevelled strength in agony 8
Disproving thy man's name*: and while before
The world thou burnest in a poet-fire,
We see thy woman-heart beat evermore
Through the large flame. Beat purer, heart, and higher,
Till God unsex thee on the heavenly shore 13
Where unincarnate spirits purely aspire!

George Sand is the pseudonym of Amantine-Lucile-Aurore Dupin, a nineteenth-century author who, like Mary Ann Evan, took a man's name in order to publish.

54. The societal expectations regarding women, against which Elizabeth Barrett Browning's praise of George Sand finds expression in this sonnet, are best summarized in the imagery of

A) line 1.
B) line 4.
C) line 6.
D) line 11.
E) line 13.

55. The world's burning in line 10's "poet-fire," imagery that is repeated in line 12's "large flame," refers to the novelist George Sand's

A) artistic inspiration.
B) lack of culinary expertise.
C) need to see her old boyfriend.
D) pseudonymic carelessness.
E) pyromaniacal inclination.

56. The aspect of George Sand's appearance that the poem's speaker singles out as the apparently open defiance of Sand's having adopted a male pseudonym is/are the

A) broken gauds.
B) manly armlets.
C) unsexed heavenly shore.
D) unshorn floating hair.
E) voice forlorn.

57. Lines 1, 4, 5, and 8 are examples of

A) eye rhyme.
B) feminine rhyme.
C) half rhyme.
D) leonine rhyme.
E) *rime riche*.

58. Browning's sonnet is a near-perfect

A) Anglo-Italian sonnet.
B) English sonnet.
C) Italian sonnet.
D) Miltonic sonnet.
E) Spenserian sonnet.

Items 59-60 refer to George Eliot's

'Mid My Gold-Brown Curls

'Mid my gold-brown curls
There twined a silver hair:
I plucked it idly out
And scarcely knew 'twas there. 4
Coiled in my velvet sleeve it lay
And like a serpent hissed:
"Me thou canst pluck and fling away,
One hair is lightly missed; 8
But how on that near day
When all the wintry army muster* in array?"

* **to assemble**

59. Thematically, the concern seriously expressed in George Eliot's (Mary Ann Evan's) "'Mid My Gold-Brown Curls" is the

A) inevitability of aging.
B) infelicity of shed hair on fine attire.
C) insecurity associated with aging.
D) intransigence of Samuel L. Jackson's nemeses.
E) unenviable worry about turning gray.

60. The visual imagery that is found in the single strand of hair's question (lines 7-10) is/are

A) drifts of snow.
B) Medusa's snake-locks.
C) the speaker's hair.
D) the speaker's mourners at her winter funeral.
E) winter-camouflaged soldiers.

Items 61-65 refer to Thom Gunn's

The Secret Sharer*

Over the ankles in snow and numb past pain
I stared up at my window three stories high:
From a white street unconcerned as a dead eye,
I patiently called my name again and again.

The curtains were lit, through glass were lit by doubt
And there was I, within the room alone.
In the empty wind I stood and shouted on:
But O, what if the strange head should peer out?

Suspended taut between two equal fears
I was like to be torn apart by their strong pull:
What, I asked, if I never hear my call?
And what if it reaches my sensitive ears?

Fixed in my socket of thought I saw them move
Aside, I saw that some uncertain hand
Had touched the curtains. Mine, I wondered? And,
At this instant, the wind turned in its groove.

The wind turns in its groove and I am here
Lying in bed, the snow and street outside;
Fire-glow still reassuring; dark defied.
The wind turns in its groove: I am still there.

***Titled after a Joseph Conrad novel in which story a ship's captain hides a stowaway in his own room and experiences a sense of watching his other self.**

61. The literary archetype upon which Thom Gunn bases the allusory concern in his poem "The Secret Sharer" is the
    A) antihero.
    B) braggadocio.
    C) doppelgänger.
    D) double entendre.
    E) twiner.

62. The stanzaic form that characterizes Gunn's poem is the
    A) ballad stanza.
    B) englyn.
    C) heroic quatrain.
    D) quatorzain.
    E) quatrain.

63. The figure of speech represented by line 5's "lit by doubt" is
    A) conceit.
    B) hyperbole.
    C) litotes.
    D) paradox.
    E) zeugma.

64. The species of end rhyme found in lines 1 and 4 and in lines 17 and 20 is
    A) macaronic rhyme.
    B) near rhyme.
    C) onomatopoeia.
    D) *rime riche*.
    E) wrenched rhyme.

65. The focus of the theme of Gunn's poem is the
    A) concern regarding personal identity.
    B) fright that comes with nightmares.
    C) psychiatry of self-stalking.
    D) sharing of warm housing with the homeless.
    E) ubiquity of schizophrenic versification.

Required tie-breaking essay prompt on the next page.

Part 4: Tie-Breaking Essay (required)

Note well: Contestants who do not write an essay will be disqualified even if they are not involved in any tie.

Note well: Any essay that does not demonstrate a sincere effort to discuss the assigned topic will be disqualified. The judge(s) should note carefully this criterion when breaking ties: ranking of essays for tie-breaking purposes should be based primarily on how well the topic has been addressed.

Three sheets of paper have been provided for this essay; your written response should reflect the *Handbook*'s notion that an essay is a "moderately brief discussion of a restricted topic": something more than just a few sentences.

Read Emily Dickinson's "[Nature, the gentlest mother]," and address the poet's characterization of nature.

[Nature, the gentlest mother]

Nature, the gentlest mother,
Impatient of no child,
The feeblest of the waywardest,—
Her admonition mild

In forest and the hill
By traveller is heard,
Restraining rampant squirrel
Or too impetuous bird.

How fair her conversation
A summer afternoon,—
Her household, her assembly;
And when the sun goes down

Her voice among the aisles
Incites the timid prayer
Of the minutest cricket,
The most unworthy flower.

When all the children sleep
She turns as long away
As will suffice to light her lamps;
Then, bending from the sky,

With infinite affection
An infiniter care,
Her golden finger on her lip,
Wills silence everywhere.

Emily Dickinson

ANSWER SHEET

UIL Literary Criticism

Items 1-30 **1** *point each*

1. ____
2. ____
3. ____
4. ____
5. ____
6. ____
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28. ____
29. ____
30. ____

Items 31-65 **2** *points each*

31. ____
32. ____
33. ____
34. ____
35. ____
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52. ____
53. ____
54. ____
55. ____
56. ____
57. ____
58. ____
59. ____
60. ____
61. ____
62. ____
63. ____
64. ____
65. ____

Part 3

contestant number

SCORE

Please note that the objective scores should not be altered to reflect the breaking of any ties.

Simply adjust ranking.

The thirty items in Part 1 are worth one point each.

The twenty items in Part 2 are worth two points each.

The fifteen items in Part 3 are worth two points each.

FIRST GRADER

number correct x 1 _____

\+

number correct x 2 _____

= _____

_____
initials

SECOND GRADER

number correct x 1 _____

\+

number correct x 2 _____

= _____

_____
initials

THIRD GRADER

number correct x 1 _____

\+

number correct x 2 _____

= _____

_____
initials

KEY

UIL Literary Criticism
District 2 • 2015

line arrows up ➔

1.	B	71
2.	D	435
3.	A	24
4.	D	600
5.	C	267
6.	B	66
7.	B	43
8.	E	605
9.	A	45
10.	A	603
11.	A	61
12.	C	244
13.	D	239
14.	D	592
15.	D	540
16.	E	424
17.	B	151
18.	C	326
19.	D	455
20.	B	558
21.	B	76
22.	C	548
23.	E	268
24.	E	412
25.	E	491
26.	D	155
27.	A	51
28.	B	19
29.	A	607
30.	D	293
31.	C	67
32.	E	49
33.	E	70
34.	A	113/73
35.	E	100
36.	B	90
37.	C	267-68
38.	D	470
39.	E	2650 ff.
40.	B	767
41.	C	2910 ff.
42.	B	1590
43.	C	174
44.	D	
45.	B	107
46.	A	
47.	E	
48.	A	
49.	E	469
50.	C	273
51.	C	167
52.	C	
53.	E	
54.	B	
55.	A	
56.	D	
57.	A	191
58.	D	300
59.	A	
60.	C	
61.	C	151
62.	E	395
63.	D	349
64.	B	318
65.	A	

FOLD along the **three** longitudinal lines for ease in grading. ➔

Please note that the objective scores should not be altered to reflect the breaking of any ties. ***Simply adjust ranking***.

The thirty items in Part 1 are worth one point each.

The twenty items in Part 2 are worth two points each.

The fifteen items in Part 3 are worth two points each.

DO NOT mark (cross out) actual **LETTER** answer; mark the answer **NUMERAL**.

Page numbers refer to the *Handbook* 12e, to the Signet *House*, to the Norton *Beowulf*, and to Collins's Dickinson collection.

Part 4: Tie-Breaking Essay

These notes are not intended to be understood as a key for the Tie-Breaking Essay prompt; rather, they should serve the judge(s) as a presentation of critical ideas that might appear in an essay responding to the prompt.

Criteria for judging the Tie-Breaking Essay **SHOULD** include

the degree to which the instructions have been followed,

the quality of the critical insight offered in response to the selection,

the overall effectiveness of the written discussion, and

the grammatical correctness of the essay.

Note well that the quality of the contestant's critical insight is more important than the contestant's prose style. In short, the Literary Criticism contest is one that promotes the critical analysis of literature. The quality of the writing, which should never go unappreciated, does not trump evidence of critical analysis.

Critical Notes on Emily Dickinson's "[Nature, the gentlest mothers]"

Literary concepts that MIGHT be used in a discussion of Emily Dickinson's characterization of nature in "[Nature, the gentlest of mothers]" include

alliteration,
anthropomorphism,
characterization,
connotation,
consonance,
enjambment,
imagery,
litotes,
metaphor,
paradox,
pathetic fallacy,
personification,
sigmatism,
speaker,
synecdoche, and
tone.

Dickinson's personification of nature as mother is nothing new; however, Dickinson's characterization develops the maternal aspects through metaphor and imagery in a manner that the contestant should be able to appreciate. The young writer should note the patience, care, and affection that the speaker presents as the hallmarks of our personified nature's gentleness. Nature's rôle as caretaker of the forest's denizens is emphasized in the enjambed lines of the first two stanzas—"Her admonition mild / In forest and the hill / By traveler is heard"—and apparently recognized, a recognition that allows the anthropomorphizing of the forest critters: the rampant squirrel and the impetuous bird.

The contestant might recognize the mild admonition (line 4) as pathetic fallacy, and so also nature's "fair conversation" (line 9); both can be argued to be an endowing of nature with human emotion, the mildness and the fairness exceeding the simpler care and affection that are usually ascribed to both the sentient constituents of the natural world and the collective that is nature herself. Indeed, the description of the squirrel as rampant and the bird as impetuous might be seen as pathetic fallacy.

Something might be made of the metaphor and the synecdoche that suggest the forest as church: nature's "voice among the aisles," as well as the cricket's "timid prayer"; both of which are prefaced with a reference to nature's "assembly."